23 First wave had come through Tīmūr himself in AD 1398. In words of his biographer, Yazdi, ‘Tīmūr’s only aim till his death was to excite the Mussalmans to make war on enemy of their religion, (. . .) and Al-Quran praises above all others, those who risk their fortunes and lives in such a war’. (Yazdī, 1723)

24 Translated by author based on the Persian manuscript available in National Museum, New Delhi. This is copy of the MS of translated version of one commissioned under Akbar in 1589.

25 *Baburnama* was translated in English from Turkic by British Orientalist Annette Susannah Beveridge in 1922 (Beveridge, 1922). She used the Turkic version called the Haidarabad Codex (1915). Akbar had got it translated in Persian in AD 1589.

26 Interestingly, though the area of Akbar’s extent was only 0.85 million sq. miles (Habib, 1982), way lesser than Maratha Empire at its peak academicians haven’t hesitated to call his empire as ‘Hindustan’ while neglecting to address ‘Haindavi Swarajya’ of latter as empire of Bharat.

27 Timur’s Biographer Yazdi writes, ‘God hath recommended to Mahomet to excite the Muslamans to make war on the enemies of their religion, because it is the most excellent of all actions, and Alcoran praises above all others, those who risk their fortunes and lives in such a war.

> ‘This was Timur’s only aim, from the beginning of his life to his death, but he particularly executed at this time by beginning a war which he had a long while projected.’ (Yazdī, 1723)